MC 501 Extended Codebook and Reliability Protocol rubric

75 points. Due Monday, November 2, 11:59 PM.

How this is scored. Add the points from each row; the total is out of 75. A first attempt is graded forgivingly: a part that is there but incomplete earns partial credit, and 0 is kept for a part that is missing. Length: the codebook 1,200 to 2,000 words, counting its variable and example tables, and the reliability protocol 500 to 900 words. Word counts cover your own writing, not the title, headings, tables, references, figure captions, code, or output, and writing more than the range never costs points. Scores on work that shows effort are adjusted with the course's curve: your final percentage is 25 percent plus 75 percent of your rubric percentage, so 50 of 100 on the rubric becomes 62.5. Work at two-thirds or more of the minimum length counts as showing effort. Attempts are unlimited, so you can revise an early submission right up to the deadline.

- The codebook rows total 40 and the protocol rows 35. Rows 6 to 10 are the five parts of the reliability protocol.
- You are the only coder. Every reliability claim you make is a claim about your own consistency, and the protocol says so in those words.
- In this course about 10 percent is enough to practice the mechanics; a study meant for publication re-codes 10 to 20 percent of its items.
- Safeguards to choose from: writing every category's inclusion and exclusion rule before coding begins; two or three prototypical examples per category drawn from your material; freezing the codebook before the full pass and logging every later change with its date and reason; keeping an ambiguous-case memo and settling each case against the written rule instead of by feel; coding in a fixed order with source details hidden wherever that is possible.

Extended Codebook and Reliability Protocol, 75 points

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Codebook: study overview 4 points	**4 points.** Names the question, the material you are coding, and the time period.	**3 points.** Names two of the three.	**2 points.** Present, but a reader still could not say what is coded or from when.	**0 to 1 points.** Missing.

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Codebook: unit of analysis 10 points	**10 points.** States exactly what one coded item is, once, and every variable is coded on that item.	**8 to 9 points.** Stated, but a variable is coded on something else (for example, the unit is one post but a variable describes the whole account).	**5 to 7 points.** Stated loosely, so a reader could not tell where one item ends and the next begins.	**0 to 4 points.** Not stated.
Codebook: every variable 10 points	**10 points.** Every variable carries all six elements from Definitions Practice.	**8 to 9 points.** Every variable is here, but one or two are missing an element.	**5 to 7 points.** Several variables are missing elements, or a variable is listed by name only.	**0 to 4 points.** Variables are named without definitions.
Codebook: decision rules 8 points	**8 points.** Rules for the cases that do not sort themselves, each written as a rule, covering the hard calls you actually met.	**6 to 7 points.** Rules are there, but at least one is an intention instead of a rule.	**4 to 5 points.** One or two rules for the whole codebook.	**0 to 3 points.** None.
Codebook: examples 8 points	**8 points.** Two or three examples per category, drawn from your own material.	**6 to 7 points.** Examples for every category, but some are invented or there is only one per category.	**4 to 5 points.** Examples for some categories only.	**0 to 3 points.** No examples.

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
6. The statistic and its threshold 9 points	**9 points.** Names the statistic with one sentence on why it and not another, calls it intracoder reliability (stability), not intercoder agreement, and says why percent agreement alone is not enough. Gives a threshold with its source, and one sentence saying a stability figure is a weaker claim than agreement between two coders and cannot be reported as if it were one.	**7 to 8 points.** Statistic and threshold are both named with a reason and a source, but one piece is missing: the weakness of percent agreement, or the weaker-claim sentence, or the wording slips into "intercoder".	**5 to 6 points.** Percent agreement alone, a statistic named with no reason, or a threshold with no source.	**0 to 4 points.** Missing.
7. The stability procedure and a fresh sample 8 points	**8 points.** At least 10 percent of your coded items, re-coded by you after at least 48 hours with your first codes hidden, drawn from a sample kept separate from the items you used to build and revise the codebook, with its size and how it is drawn.	**6 to 7 points.** One condition is missing: the 10 percent, the 48 hours, hidden first codes, the sample's size, or how it is drawn.	**4 to 5 points.** Two or more conditions are missing, or it is unclear whether the sample is separate.	**0 to 3 points.** Missing, or the re-code uses the items the codebook was built on, which makes the stability figure read higher than it should.

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
8. When it fails, and reporting a disappointing number 8 points	**8 points.** Says in advance what you do if the figure misses the threshold: which categories you revise, how, and what keeps the codebook from bending toward your habits. Commits to reporting the figure even if it is disappointing, and says what you will say about it.	**6 to 7 points.** Both parts are there, but nothing guards against fitting the codebook to your habits, or the commitment to report does not say what you would say about a low figure.	**4 to 5 points.** "I will revise the codebook," with no rule, or reporting is mentioned in passing with no commitment.	**0 to 3 points.** Missing.
9. Single-coder safeguards 5 points	**5 points.** At least three safeguards you are actually using, each named and described as what you do.	**4 points.** Three named, but one is not described.	**3 points.** One or two safeguards.	**0 to 2 points.** None.
10. Second-coder counterfactual 5 points	**5 points.** One paragraph: how many items you would double-code, which statistic you would report, how you would train and settle disagreements, and which finding is most at risk.	**4 points.** Three of the four.	**3 points.** Two or fewer, or the protocol describes a second coder as if one were part of your study.	**0 to 2 points.** Missing.

Before you submit

Codebook Check reads a pasted codebook and reports what this assignment asks for that your draft does not have yet: a unit of analysis stated once, both definitions on every variable, a declared level of measurement, a catch-all category, a description on every category, category pairs that may overlap, decision rules, and examples. It does not grade, and nothing you enter leaves your machine.

Agreement Check takes your two coding passes as two columns and returns percent agreement, the statistic with its threshold, and the items the two passes disagree on. Set it to one coder, two passes. It does not grade, and nothing you enter leaves your machine.